APPROVED ON OCTOBER 7, 2026
BY THE BOARD OF COUNTY COMMISSIONERS
AT THE WEEKLY BUSINESS SESSION

County Administration Workshop: September 29, 2026
1:30 p.m. – Board of Commissioners Conference Room
Attending: Commissioners Ron A. Smith; Colene M. Martin; Gary L. Richardson; and Nikole Guzman, Recorder

Chair Ron Smith called the meeting to order at 1:30 p.m. The Board took the Human Resources item first, then returned to the posted department order.

1. **Declaration of Potential Conflicts of Interest**

   Commissioners Richardson and Martin each declared no potential conflicts of interest. Chair Smith did not declare a conflict.

2. **Department Business**

   a. **Forestry**

      1. **Seedling Growing Service Contract 2027A-114 with Weyerhaeuser NR Company for reforestation of Josephine County lands – $120,280 – Approve contract and authorize Dave Streeter to electronically sign**

Dave Streeter, Forestry Director, requested approval of Seedling Growing Service Contract 2027A-114 with Weyerhaeuser NR Company, covering approximately 190,000 seedlings for future reforestation of Josephine County lands. He described the informal solicitation of nurseries and evaluation of seedling quality and value, explaining that the County uses both one-year container-grown plugs and two-year bare-root stock. Ordering in advance of anticipated timber harvests helps the County replant promptly and avoid the cost of replacing lower-quality stock. The multi-year contract totals $120,280.

Commissioner Martin moved to approve Seedling Growing Service Contract 2027A-114 with Weyerhaeuser NR Company for $120,280 and authorize Dave Streeter to sign electronically. Commissioner Richardson seconded the motion. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - Yes; Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Yes. Motion carried 3-0.

   b. **Recreation**

      1. **CXT Upper Loop Restroom Purchase for the newly renovated loop at Whitehorse Park – State of Oregon Contract #1542 – $146,883**

Tamra Martin, Recreation Director, proposed purchasing a modular CXT Dakota restroom to serve the renovated upper camping loop at Whitehorse Park, where the existing lower restroom is a considerable distance away. She explained that the $146,883 purchase was planned with ARPA funding, but she had just learned the installation, not merely the purchase, might have to be completed by December 31, 2026. The original installation was planned for March 2027. She was confirming whether the vendor could deliver and install the unit within the earlier deadline; County staff could prepare the site. If the timeline or ARPA funding could not be secured, she expected to place the project on hold and reconsider funding and timing, including potential capital-reserve funds. She requested conditional signing authority to proceed promptly only if the funding and schedule proved workable.

Commissioner Martin moved to authorize Tamra Martin to sign the purchase documents for the CXT restroom at Whitehorse Park under State of Oregon Contract No. 1542 for $146,883, provided the project qualifies for the intended funding and can meet the required completion timeline. Commissioner Richardson seconded the motion. The Board requested that Ms. Martin keep it informed. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - Yes; Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Yes. Motion carried 3-0.

c. **Transit**

1. **Amendment Number 1 to ODOT Grant Agreement No. 35902 – Change the Statement of Work from "replacement vehicles" to "expansion vehicles" – $288,000 grant with $72,000 match – Approval and signature**

Scott Chancey, Transit Program Supervisor, presented Amendment No. 1 to ODOT Grant Agreement No. 35902. ODOT had inadvertently used the statement of work for replacement vehicles on a grant intended to purchase two additional, or expansion, vehicles. Mr. Chancey explained that the error duplicated vehicle identification numbers appearing on a separate replacement-vehicle grant. The amendment corrects the classification without changing the $288,000 grant or $72,000 local match. ODOT required the signed correction before Transit could place the vehicle order. Mr. Chancey noted that the County was coordinating orders across several grants to obtain purchase efficiencies and that vehicle delivery can take approximately six to ten months.

Commissioner Martin moved to approve Amendment No. 1 to ODOT Grant Agreement No. 35902 for the Board's signature so Transit could proceed with its vehicle purchase. Commissioner Richardson seconded the motion. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - Yes; Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Yes. Motion carried 3-0.

d. **Planning**

1. **Findings of Fact and Decision – Appeal of a Director's Decision to Approve a Processing Facility at 2581 Dick George Road, Cave Junction (Appellant: Joe & Bonnie Campanoli; Applicant: Columbia Wholesale LLC) – Approved by the Board on August 31, 2026**

James Black, Planning and Terri Woodruff, Associate Planner, presented the Findings of Fact and Decision arising from the appeal by Joe and Bonnie Campanoli concerning Columbia Wholesale LLC's proposed processing facility at 2581 Dick George Road, Cave Junction. The Board had heard the appeal on August 24 and continued it on August 31, when it affirmed the approval subject to additional conditions. Staff reviewed the conditions reflected in Exhibit B, including no water use in processing, access for processing activities from Dick George Road rather than Greenview Road, and carbon filtration for odor control. Following approval of the written findings, staff would issue and mail the notice of decision to participants; a 21-day appeal period would precede further permitting if no appeal were filed.

Commissioner Richardson moved to approve the Findings of Fact and Decision for the appeal of the Director's approval of the processing facility at 2581 Dick George Road, including the conditions presented in Exhibit B. Commissioner Martin seconded the motion. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - Yes; Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Yes. Motion carried 3-0.

e. **Human Resources**

1. **Position Requisition**

a. Public Health Animal Shelter - Shelter Technician - Two (2) Additional Part-time Positions and Existing Employee FTE Adjustment

b. Board of Commissioners Office - Board Administrative Secretary - Refill as Part-time; Adjust FTE

c. Legal Counsel - Law Library Assistant - Refill Part-time Vacated Position

d. Sheriff - Corporal Patrol - Proposed Requisition Withdrawn (Employee Remaining)

e. Sheriff - Deputy Corrections - Refill Position Vacated May 6, 2026

f. Public Works - Fleet Program Supervisor - Refill Vacated Position

g. Public Works - Road Worker I - Three (3) Temporary Positions

Natalie Eckhardt-Doupe, Interim Human Resources Director, presented these requests at the start of the workshop. Animal Shelter staffing was revised from three new part-time positions to two, with an existing employee increasing from 0.7 to 0.8 FTE. The Board Administrative Secretary position was ready for part-time recruitment following revision of its job description. Legal Counsel requested a refill of its budgeted part-time Law Library Assistant position. The Sheriff's Patrol Corporal had withdrawn the planned resignation, so that requisition was removed; the Corrections Deputy vacancy still required recruitment. Public Works requested recruitment of its Fleet Program Supervisor following the director's review and three temporary Road Worker I positions after recent departures. The temporary workers would be evaluated during the six-month period provided under the applicable collective bargaining agreement before any transition to regular employment. Human Resources was directed to proceed with the revised requests; no separate motion or roll-call vote was recorded.

3. **Board Business**

   a. **Josephine County Republican Central Committee Application for Anne G. Basker Auditorium Rental – Request to change date from November 12, 2026 to November 19, 2026**

      The Board approved without objection the Josephine County Republican Central Committee's request to change its Anne G. Basker Auditorium reservation from November 12 to November 19, 2026.

   b. **Consolidation Estates Subdivision Plat Map Approval**

      Commissioner Martin moved to approve the Consolidation Estates Subdivision plat map. Commissioner Richardson seconded the motion. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - Yes; Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Yes. Motion carried 3-0.

   c. **Sheriff's Office Budgeted Positions**

      Commissioner Richardson discussed six budgeted Sheriff's Office positions that would remain unfilled due to budget constraints: two Patrol Deputy, two Corrections Deputy, and two Major Crimes Detective positions. He explained that the reductions had been discussed during the supplemental-budget process, but Finance had subsequently finalized the corresponding FTE adjustments following the negotiated collective bargaining agreements. The Board considered also presenting the matter at a Weekly Business Session for public awareness, while noting agenda-posting time and confirming coordination with the Sheriff's Office.

      Commissioner Richardson moved to adjust the Sheriff's Office budgeted FTE by removing the six identified unfilled positions. Commissioner Martin seconded the motion. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - Yes; Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Yes. Motion carried 3-0. The Board discussed bringing the matter to a future Weekly Business Session for additional public awareness.

4. **OTHER**

   The Board discussed a proposed Outstanding Resource Waters designation affecting Illinois Valley watersheds. Commissioners raised questions about possible implications for Cave Junction, industrial property, federal-land management, wildfire mitigation, and invasive-weed control. They also discussed seasonal low water flows and high temperatures in the Illinois River. Commissioner Richardson stated that he was gathering additional information and might return with a proposed resolution for consideration during the coming legislative session. No formal action was taken.

5. **ADDITIONAL SUBJECT MATTERS FROM COMMISSIONERS/ANNOUNCEMENTS:**

During announcements, the Board noted that fire season was nearing its end but residents should continue to exercise caution until substantial rain arrives. Chair Smith adjourned the meeting at 1:59 p.m.